

While the feel of the keyboard is typical of the ThinkPad and gives good feedback, we found the trackpad to be a bit of a let-down. Configure as we may, it remained slippery to the point of being inaccurate. This is grave injustice indeed, and to business users whom a USB mouse is another lump of plastic to carry



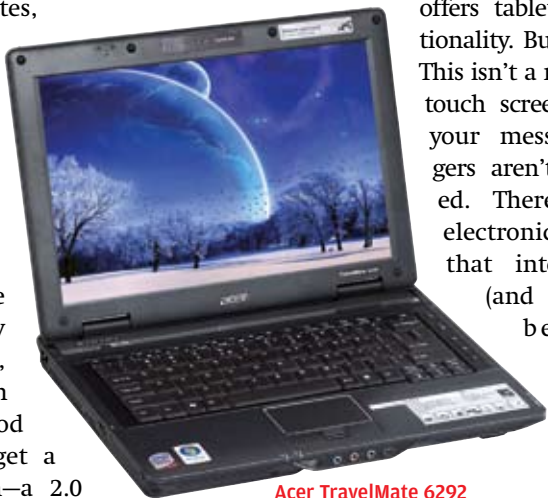
Lenovo ThinkPad X300

around, we figure Lenovo should take a look at this issue. Biometric logins are a pleasure, courtesy the easy-to-use fingerprint reader.

Such a well crafted, ruggedly built notebook was never expected to be cheap, and with solid state storage to boot, the price tag of Rs 1,45,000 is hardly budget-friendly, but it's still worth it. It's got one quirk, and that aside total peace of mind. We figure those who really understand what ThinkPads are all about will take the plunge and shell out.

Acer TravelMate 6292

Acer's answer to the corporate executive's prayers, the TravelMate series are typically business notebooks, and a single glance at them and their stable mates, the Aspire series, will tell you why. Industrial grade finishes, and a magnesium / aluminium alloy on the lid that is both lightweight and durable, makes the TravelMate worthy of its name. Inside, the 12.1-inch screen is crisp with good colours. You also get a good configuration—a 2.0



Acer TravelMate 6292

GHz Core 2 Duo T7300 processor and 2 GB of RAM. Acer is admittedly shy on the software bundle side of things, but all the essentials, like an office suite and firewall program have been provided. The keypad is nicely sculpted and feels good to use. However, once again the layout is a bit of an issue with keys seeming too close together for people with larger fingers. Feedback is right on the sweet spot though.

At Rs 52,999, the TravelMate 6292 is a good break from all the costlier Business class notebooks. It's small footprint (12.1 inches) is only let down by a slightly bulky body. Although it's built well, it lacks that attractive feel that makes people go "ooh" when they see one.

HP Compaq 2710P

For those corporate users who want a little more than what the ThinkPad offers, the 2710P may be just up your alley. It's built mostly out of some kind of lightweight alloy and feels remarkably sturdy. It's got an even faster processor than the X300—the 2.0 GHz U7600, does its duty under the hood. A sleek laptop and one that offers tablet functionality. But wait! This isn't a normal touch screen and your messy fingers aren't invited. There's an electronic pen that interfaces (and rather beautifully) with the



HP Compaq 2710P

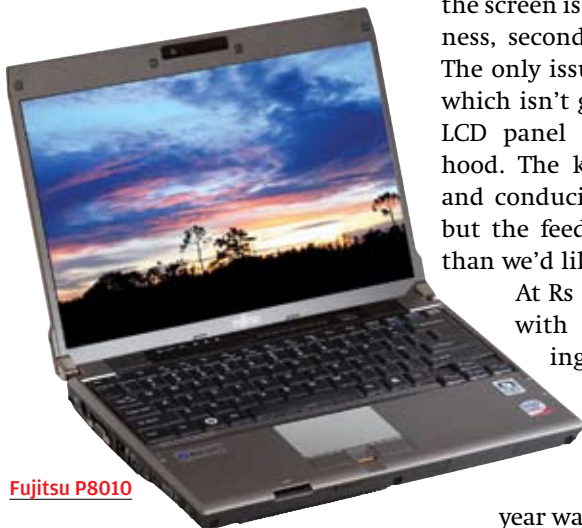
strength and a biometrics fingerprint reader too.

On the hardware front, we have no complaints aside from the measly 1 GB of RAM. The target audience is unlikely to need extra storage space or a video solution, so the 2710P passes scrutiny in this regard. At Rs 110,000, we figure that most business users who go for this, will either look to save Rs 35,000 (the difference between this and the Lenovo X300) or desire the show of a touch screen. Whatever the reason, at this price, this is a good—albeit slightly overpriced—solution for the target audience.

Fujitsu P8010

An attractive notebook with a glossy lid, that's strangely—and not unattractively—liveried in dull orange. It's extremely light, even for a compact 12.1-inch notebook. The screen is crisp. Fujitsu does have this tradition of soft keys, and frankly this is a trend we hope discontinues. Why?

crisp, and bright screen. Handwriting recognition is a delight to use, and isn't just a gimmick—it's very functional as well. You'll find yourself scribbling notes, writing out e-mails and doing just about every task that requires typing with the pen instead. While still on the topic of ergonomics, brilliance comes at a severe price. There's no touchpad, just a ThinkPad-like mouse button that takes a lot of getting used to. There's an inbuilt WiFi antenna that can be extruded to increase signal



Fujitsu P8010

Not enough tactile feedback.

It's aimed at business users, and the P8010 is all business. With a battery backup time of more than two hours with video playback, the P8010 will satisfy the corporate exec on the go. 2 GB of RAM makes Vista snappy, if not blazingly fast, and this will be enough for most corporate users.

At Rs 1,05,100, however, the P8010 doesn't do anything radically different to justify such a price tag. We figure at this price you would be better served by the HP Compaq 2710P, which adds a utilitarian touchscreen to the package.

Fujitsu S6410

Built around slim lines, the S6410 is an ultra portable 13.3-inch laptop oriented towards the discerning businessman who travels a lot. It's very light at 1.7 kg, and built well enough to cart around. The industrial-grade charcoal grey finish is attractive, but in a suave, non-intrusive sort of way. It's got a strong configuration that will pull it through most situations—like a 2.2 GHz Core 2 Duo T7500 and 2 GB of RAM. There's also a host of software options available for business users and MS Office 2007 is part of the package as well. What we really liked about

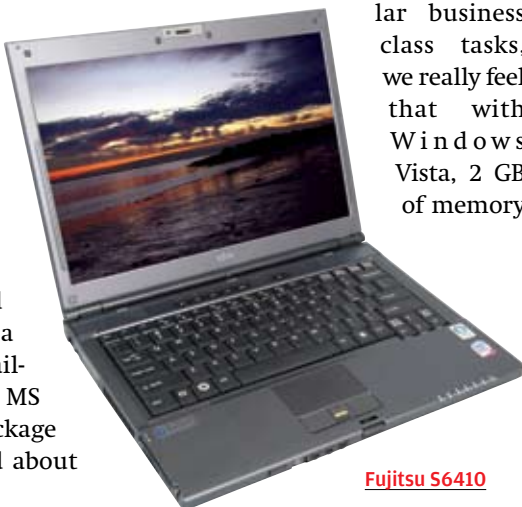
the screen is its crispness and brightness, second only to Sony displays. The only issue is the viewing angle, which isn't good. It seems like a TN LCD panel doing duty under the hood. The keypad is well laid out and conducive to some fast typing, but the feedback is a little soggy than we'd like.

At Rs 74,000, the S6410 brings with it a solid computing experience, and a well built, compact machine capable of most business oriented tasks. The three-year warranty that Fujitsu provides, makes this a very attractive laptop for those who don't want to splurge on the costlier P8010.

Fujitsu Esprimo U9200

Fujitsu's U series of notebooks are meant to denote 'ultra' portability and they're aimed squarely at the business class, which is why this notebook finds itself in this category and not in the ultra portable category. It's simpler than both its similar looking siblings—the S6510 and S6410. Unfortunately, for an ultra-portable, it's a little too thick. Compare it to Sony's ultra-sleek Vaio VGN-TZ37GN/R and you'll get the feeling of a water buffalo standing next to a panther.

The looks notwithstanding, the U9200 has a powerful processor (T7500, 2.2 GHz) but only 1 GB of RAM. Although it'll be snappy enough for most regular business class tasks, we really feel that with Windows Vista, 2 GB of memory



Fujitsu S6410

should be made an industry standard for vendors.

The standout here is the superb price. At Rs 43,500, the U9200 slugs other business laptops where it hurts and as a frugal tycoon, you know it's worth every paise of its price. A three-year warranty included for the price makes this a great



Fujitsu Esprimo U9200

deal. We'd say the only possible detractions are the very plain looks, and the thickness which is unwarranted for a compact 12.1-inch notebook.

Fujitsu S6510

The bigger brother to the S6510 (14.1 inches), it's heavier as well, but by a mere 200 grams. Looks wise, they're both identical, except of course, for the slightly larger footprint. Once again the build quality of hinges and such is good. The S6510 should stand the rigours of travel quite well. We found the keypad spacing even better on this model. However, the soft soggy feedback isn't as much fun. Another great software bundle, image editing software, antivirus suite, and MS Office 2007, along with some nifty Fujitsu utilities that save battery, optimise performance, etc make the S6510 a fully loaded solution.

It's got the same configuration as its little brother, which isn't a bad thing at all. For Rs 80,000, how-